

CHAPTER 12

JOURNEY WITH MARIAM AND FAUZIYYA

'Wait, you will soon know.'

For the first time, all the accused in the ISRO spy case were together, in the police van to Ernakulam. Each of the accused was guarded by a constable; the Maldivian women had with them a woman constable each.

While the presence of the Maldivian women in the vehicle angered me, I wasn't any less irritated about the others including my colleague Sasikumaran. It appeared to me that Sasi had indeed met the women though there was no espionage possible, I knew. But it was all because of his acquaintance with the women that ISRO and I were in this soup. Above all, he had apparently confessed to the crime, dragging me too into the cesspool of a fabricated spy case.

I kept to myself throughout the journey though Sasi and Chandrasekhar tried to strike a conversation by apologising for their fake confession. They tried to smile at me once in a while as the journey progressed, but I refused to look at them.

About four hours into the journey, we reached Alleppey. On to an unused road parallel to the highway, the van pulled over, and we were given lunch—a few chapattis packed from the Pallipuram police camp, and a few bananas the policemen had bought from a shop. The van had all its windows shielded by shutters pulled down, but one of them had a gap. Through this some passersby were trying to peep in. The constables shouted